

Sam Altman – Biography

Full Name: Samuel H. Altman

Born: April 22, 1985 (St. Louis, Missouri, USA)

Occupation: Entrepreneur, Investor, CEO of OpenAI

Early Life & Education

- Grew up in **St. Louis, Missouri**, and got his first computer at age 8.
- Studied **computer science** at **Stanford University** but dropped out in 2005.

Career Highlights

1. Loopt (2005–2012)

- Co-founded **Loopt**, a location-based social networking app, at age 19.
- The startup raised **over \$30 million** but struggled to gain traction.
- Loopt was acquired by **Green Dot Corporation** for **\$43.4 million** in 2012.

2. Y Combinator (2014–2019)

- Became president of **Y Combinator (YC)**, a prestigious startup accelerator that helped launch companies like Airbnb, Dropbox, and Stripe.
- Under his leadership, YC expanded significantly and launched **YC Continuity (a late-stage investment fund)** and **YC China**.

3. OpenAI (2015–present)

- Co-founded **OpenAI** in 2015 with Elon Musk, Greg Brockman, and others, initially as a **non-profit AI research lab**.
- Became **CEO of OpenAI** in 2019, overseeing the development of **GPT-3, GPT-4, DALL·E, and ChatGPT**.
- Played a key role in securing a **multi-billion-dollar partnership with Microsoft** to develop AI responsibly.

4. Temporary Ouster & Return to OpenAI (2023)

- In **November 2023**, OpenAI's board unexpectedly **fired Altman as CEO**, leading to a major backlash.
- **Microsoft and OpenAI employees strongly supported him**, and within a week, he was **reinstated as CEO** after a leadership shake-up.

Investments & Other Work

- Early investor in **Stripe, Reddit, Airbnb, and nuclear fusion startup Helion Energy.**
- Advocates for **AI safety and universal basic income (UBI).**
- Believes **AI will be one of the most transformative technologies in history.**

Personal Life

- Lives in **California.**
- Passionate about **AI, energy, and space exploration.**

Would you like more details on any part of his journey?